

6 Machine Ethics Quiz

1. Why can law be a useful basis for AI behavior?

- A) It is time-tested, comprehensive, and can aggregate values through legitimate institutions
- B) It covers every moral choice perfectly
- C) It never changes
- D) It contains no standards

ANS:

2. Why does law use both rules and standards?

- A) To eliminate interpretation completely
- B) To balance specificity with flexibility in unforeseen cases
- C) To make every law silent
- D) To prevent adaptation

ANS:

3. What is 'silent law'?

- A) Secret legislation
- B) A law written without text
- C) Areas of life where law gives little or no behavioral guidance
- D) A law that is always immoral

ANS:

4. Why should AI ethics go beyond legal compliance?

- A) Law is never legitimate
- B) Ethics is always programmable as a simple rule
- C) Legal systems have no useful information
- D) Law can be incomplete, immoral, or unrepresentative

ANS:

5. What is reasonable care?

- A) The caution a prudent person would use to avoid foreseeable harm
- B) Obeying only explicit criminal prohibitions
- C) Maximizing profit regardless of harm
- D) Ignoring vulnerable users

ANS:

6. What is a moral hazard?

- A) A party bears all consequences of its own risk
- B) A party takes risks while others bear much of the downside
- C) A moral theory under uncertainty
- D) A type of social welfare function

ANS:

7. What is risk internalization?

- A) Transferring every cost to society
- B) Ignoring externalities
- C) Making the risk-taking party bear the consequences of its choices
- D) Eliminating all business activity

ANS:

8. Why is GDP not equivalent to social wellbeing?

- A) GDP measures happiness directly
- B) GDP includes every unpaid activity
- C) GDP cannot increase
- D) GDP omits many valuable activities and can rise while wellbeing falls

ANS:

9. What is wellbeing as preference satisfaction?

- A) Wellbeing consists in having one's preferences or desires fulfilled
- B) Wellbeing equals national income
- C) Wellbeing requires only pleasure
- D) Wellbeing ignores choices

ANS:

10. What are revealed preferences?

- A) What a person would choose if fully informed
- B) Preferences inferred from what people actually choose
- C) Only answers to surveys
- D) A list of objective goods

ANS:

11. What are stated preferences?

- A) Observed purchases only
- B) Choices made under manipulation
- C) What people report or say they prefer
- D) Preferences assigned by law

ANS:

12. What are idealized preferences?

- A) Whatever someone does impulsively
- B) Whatever increases GDP
- C) Preferences imposed by a company
- D) What a fully informed and suitably rational person would choose

ANS:

13. What does objective-goods theory claim?

- A) Some things can benefit a person independently of their current preferences
- B) Only revealed preferences matter
- C) Nothing is objectively good
- D) All goods reduce to money

ANS:

14. What does a social welfare function do?

- A) Predicts one person's next click
- B) Aggregates individual wellbeing into a measure of societal welfare
- C) Eliminates interpersonal effects
- D) Measures processor utilization

ANS:

15. Which option does a utilitarian social welfare function select?

- A) The option favored by the richest person
- B) The option with the highest minimum only
- C) The option with the highest total wellbeing
- D) The option with the fewest voters

ANS:

16. What does Rawlsian maximin prioritize?

- A) The largest total regardless of distribution
- B) The median person's preference
- C) The strongest corporation
- D) The option that makes the worst-off outcome as good as possible

ANS:

17. What is moral uncertainty?

- A)** Uncertainty about which moral theory is correct
- B)** Uncertainty about model latency
- C)** Ignorance of all factual evidence
- D)** A refusal to consider ethics

ANS:

18. What is a credence?

- A)** A legal requirement
- B)** A probability assigned to the possibility that a view or theory is true
- C)** A revealed preference
- D)** A social cost

ANS:

19. What is a moral parliament?

- A)** A single moral theory with full control
- B)** A random choice mechanism
- C)** A process in which representatives of multiple moral views negotiate and vote
- D)** A method that excludes uncertainty

ANS:

20. What is an advantage of an AI moral parliament?

- A)** It permanently locks in one view
- B)** It hides how values were weighted
- C)** It prevents compromise
- D)** It can represent diverse stakeholders and transparently accommodate changing moral views

ANS: